



Multi-room audio & networked systems

Plan and sync great sound through your whole home

Multi-room audio is no longer the stuff of dreams or a thing of luxury available for a chosen few elites, because with today's Wi-Fi speakers, AVRs, and streaming protocols you can start in a single room and scale to the entire house – without opening a wall. This chapter gives you a protocol-first playbook (AirPlay 2, Chromecast built-in, Alexa Multi-Room, Spotify Connect, Sonos, HEOS, MusicCast, DTS Play-Fi, Roon), then shows you how to choose hardware, design zones, harden your home network for reliable sync, and automate daily listening. We close with step-by-step recipes you can follow in less than an afternoon.

1) Know your multi-room “languages” (protocols)

Think of protocols as “audio dialects.” Pick one primary, add a secondary for flexibility.

- **AirPlay 2 (Apple)** – stream to one or many speakers in sync from iPhone, iPad, Apple TV, or Mac; you can pick multiple rooms right from Control Center or the AirPlay picker. Apple's support guide explicitly describes multi-speaker playback with AirPlay 2.
- **Quality note:** Apple Music “Lossless” goes up to 24-bit/48 kHz on supported devices; HomePod family supports lossless at up to 24/48.